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Sales Funnel Starter Pack for First-Time Online Store Owners

Starting your first online store is exciting. It can also feel like too much when you are staring at a blank phone screen, wondering where to begin. People keep telling you that you...



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What's inside

5 short sections. Read it in order, or jump to the part you need today.

01 Essential Tools in Your Sales Funnel Starter Pack

02 Your First Week Action Plan

03 Free Resources to Get More From Your Starter Pack

04 What You Do Not Need (Yet)

05 Your Next Steps

Starting your first online store is exciting. It can also feel like too much when you are staring at a blank phone screen, wondering where to begin. People keep telling you that you need a “sales funnel”. But which tools do you actually need? What should you set up first?

First, what is a sales funnel? It is simply the path a customer takes: they discover you, they get interested, they trust you, and then they buy. A good funnel makes each step easy.

Good news: you do not need a big budget or technical skills. This starter pack covers everything you need to start turning visitors into paying customers, with tools that are beginner-friendly and kind to your pocket.

01 Essential Tools in Your Sales Funnel Starter Pack

1. An Online Store (Your Foundation)

Before anything else, you need a proper place to sell, not just DMs.

What to look for:

- Easy setup from your phone
- Looks good on Android phones, where most of your customers shop
- Takes Nigerian payments: card, bank transfer and USSD through Paystack, Flutterwave or Moniepoint, plus pay on delivery
- Delivery built in or easy to arrange with GIG Logistics, Kwik Delivery, Sendbox or your own dispatch rider
- Simple reports so you can see what is selling

Options: Shopinbos gives you a store built for you by Rex, the AI store builder, with payments, deliveries and payouts to your bank every Friday already set up. It is free to start (see shopinbos.com/pricing). Foreign platforms like Shopify and WooCommerce also work, but Shopify is billed in US dollars and both need extra apps for Nigerian payments and delivery.

Cost: Free to start with Shopinbos

2. WhatsApp and Email (Your Direct Line to Customers)

Messages you send straight to customers are the backbone of any funnel. They help you build relationships and bring people back to buy again. In Nigeria, WhatsApp usually gets read faster than email, so use both.

Best beginner options:

- **WhatsApp Business:** Free. Use labels, quick replies and broadcast lists (only people who have saved your number receive broadcasts).

- **Mailchimp:** Has a free plan with basic automation for small lists. Paid plans are billed in US dollars.
- **Brevo:** Has a free plan and works well for both email and SMS.

What you will use them for: Welcome messages, reminders when someone leaves items in their cart, promo announcements and follow-ups after delivery.

Cost: Free to start

3. Lead Magnet Tools (To Collect Contacts)

A lead magnet is something valuable you give in exchange for a customer's WhatsApp number or email.

Simple lead magnet ideas:

- First-order discount (10 to 15% off)
- Free delivery within Lagos (or your city) on the first order
- Downloadable buying guide, for example "How to choose the right wig for your face shape"
- Early access to your Black Friday or Detty December sale

Tools to create them:

- **Canva:** Free design tool for flyers, discount banners and PDF guides
- **Google Forms:** Free sign-up form you can share on your Instagram bio, Status and TikTok

Cost: Free

4. Analytics (To Understand Your Customers)

You cannot improve what you do not measure. Analytics (reports on your visitors) show you where people come from and where they stop before buying.

Essential tools:

- **Google Analytics 4:** Free. Shows where your visitors come from and what they do on your store.
- **Your store's own reports:** Most store platforms, including Shopinbos, show orders, best sellers and visits.
- **Instagram and TikTok insights:** Free. Show which posts bring people to your link.

Key numbers to watch:

- Traffic sources (where visitors come from: Instagram, TikTok, WhatsApp, Google)
- Bounce rate (how many people leave without looking at anything)
- Abandoned carts (how many add items but do not pay)
- Conversion rate (out of every 100 visitors, how many actually buy)

Cost: Free

5. Social Media Tools (To Get Discovered)

The top of your funnel is about getting found. Social media is where most first-time sellers in Nigeria get their first customers.

Recommended options:

- **Meta Business Suite:** Free. Schedule posts for Instagram and Facebook in advance.
- **Canva:** Make clean product graphics and flyers.
- **CapCut:** Free video editing for TikTok and Instagram Reels.

Channels to focus on: Start with 1 or 2 where your customers already spend time, for example Instagram and WhatsApp Status for fashion, or TikTok for gadgets and beauty. Do not try to be everywhere at once.

Cost: Free

6. Customer Reviews (To Build Trust)

Customers in Nigeria want proof that you are real and that you deliver. New stores need reviews to build that trust.

Simple ways to collect reviews:

- **Google Business Profile:** Free. Customers can leave reviews that show up on Google Search and Maps.
- **WhatsApp feedback screenshots:** Ask happy customers for permission, then share their messages (hide their numbers).
- **Instagram Story Highlights:** Keep a "Reviews" highlight with customer photos and videos.

Pro tip: Ask for a review 3 to 7 days after delivery, when the customer has used the product.

Cost: Free

02 Your First Week Action Plan

You do not have to do everything at once. Here is how to prioritise:

Days 1 and 2: Set up your store

- Choose and launch your online store
- Add 5 to 10 products with clear photos, prices in naira and short descriptions

- Set up payment (card, transfer, USSD, pay on delivery) and delivery options for your city and other states

Days 3 and 4: Set up your messaging

- Set up WhatsApp Business with a catalogue, greeting message and quick replies
- Sign up for Mailchimp or Brevo and connect it to your store
- Write a simple welcome message

Days 5 and 6: Build awareness

- Create or clean up your Instagram, TikTok and Facebook pages
- Post your first content showing your products
- Set up Google Analytics and a Google Business Profile

Day 7: Launch your lead magnet

- Create a first-order discount or free delivery offer
- Add a sign-up link to your Instagram bio and WhatsApp Status
- Place a test order yourself to check that payment and delivery work

03 Free Resources to Get More From Your Starter Pack

You do not need to spend a fortune to start:

- **Canva Free:** Design flyers, social posts and lead magnets
- **Google Analytics:** Track your store visitors
- **YouTube:** Free tutorials for every tool in this pack
- **Shopinbos:** Free guides on store setup, sourcing and selling, written for Nigerian sellers

04 What You Do Not Need (Yet)

As a first-time seller, skip these until you are making steady sales:

- Big paid advert budgets (for example ₦500,000 or more)
- Complicated customer management software
- Many paid apps and plugins
- Professional photoshoots (good phone photos in daylight are fine at first)
- Complicated automated message sequences

Start simple. Confirm that people want your products. Then invest in bigger tools.

05 Your Next Steps

This starter pack gives you everything you need to start selling online without breaking the bank. Most tools have free plans or free trials, so test them before you pay.

Remember: the perfect sales funnel does not exist. What matters is starting, learning from what real customers do, and improving as you grow.

Want more step-by-step help setting up your online store? Shopinbos helps you find products from verified Nigerian suppliers, get a store built by Rex, sell on WhatsApp, Instagram, TikTok, Facebook and Google, and let Peggy, our AI assistant, help you reply to customer chats.

Your online store journey starts with the right tools. Now you have them. Time to build something great.

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Ready to make your first sale?

Rex builds your store with you in 5 minutes. Take card, transfer and pay on delivery, book riders, and let Peggy answer customers on WhatsApp.

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